

Douglas DC-9

Competing in the short-to-medium-range market with the BAC 111, which had a two-year head start, and the later Boeing 737, the DC-9, with over 2,200 sold, was much more commercially successful than the British aircraft. This was largely because the DC-9, like the 737, evolved into a large family of aircraft providing the right combination of range and payload for each airline customer. The original DC-9 Series 10 of 1965 was developed up to the 1977 DC-9 Series 80, which was evolved further as the McDonnell Douglas MD-80 series.



ENGINE 2 x 12,000lbst (5,450kgp) P&W JT8D-5 turbofan	
WINGSPAN 89ft 5in (27.3m)	LENGTH 104ft 5in (32.8m)
CRUISING SPEED 495mph (797kph)	
PASSENGERS 90	CREW 2

Fokker F.27 Mk200 Friendship



ENGINE 2 x 2,320hp Rolls-Royce Dart Mk 536 turboprop	
WINGSPAN 95ft 2in (29m)	LENGTH 77ft 4in (23.6m)
CRUISING SPEED 298mph (480kph)	
PASSENGERS 44	CREW 2

In the mid-1950s, a number of aircraft manufacturers offered "DC-3 replacements." Fokker with its F.27 were the closest to success. Together with American Fairchild-built aircraft, the design was built in greater numbers than any other turboprop outside the Soviet Union. After its first flight on November 24, 1955, over 580 had been sold to military and civil customers when production ended in favor of the improved Fokker F.50.

Ilyushin Il-18

ENGINE 4 x 4,190hp Ivchenko AI-20M turboprop	
WINGSPAN 122ft 9in (37.4m)	LENGTH 117ft 9in (35.9m)
CRUISING SPEED 419mph (674kph)	
PASSENGERS 100-120	CREW 4-5



Throughout the Cold War, the Soviet Union made a number of commercial aircraft which were based on Western designs. The Il-18 resembled the Lockheed Electra and the Vickers Vanguard. However, with over 550 built between 1957 and 1979, production of the Il-18 was more numerous than its western counterparts. The "Moskva," as it was called by its manufacturer, was exported to most of the Warsaw Pact countries and many are still in use with Central and Eastern European carriers today. A military version (Il-20) also exists.

Tupolev Tu-104A

The arrival of the prototype Tu-104 at London Airport on March 22, 1956, was the first the West knew of the Soviet Union's first jet airliner. With the early Comets grounded and Boeing's 707 still two years from service, the impact was immense. Developed from the Tu-16 "Badger" medium bomber, the Tu-104 began the first Soviet internal jet service in September 1956 carrying just 50 passengers. The improved 104A set a number of commercial records and was the most numerous out of all the Tu-104s built.

ENGINE 2 x 21,385lbst (9,710kgp) Mikulin AM-3M turbojet	
WINGSPAN 113ft 4in (34.5m)	LENGTH 127ft 6in (38.9m)
CRUISING SPEED 478mph (770kph)	
PASSENGERS 70	CREW 4



Vickers Super VC10



The VC10 was designed in 1958 as a new long-range airliner for BOAC. Though extremely popular with passengers, the VC10 series failed to win large orders because they were less economical than their 707 and DC-8 rivals. By 1969, VC10s were in use on all BOAC's long-distance routes, but were phased out in the early 1970s with the introduction of Boeing 747s.

ENGINE 4 x 22,500lb (10,205kg) Rolls-Royce Conway 550 turbofan	
WINGSPAN 146ft 2in (44.6m)	LENGTH 171ft 5in (52.3m)
CRUISING SPEED 568mph (914kph)	
PASSENGERS 174	CREW 9-11

Vickers Viscount 701

The Viscount was the first turboprop aircraft to operate a commercial passenger service and the first British airliner to achieve substantial sales in North America. The small 32-passenger prototype made its maiden flight in 1948 and entered BEA service in April 1953. The last aircraft was delivered in 1964, bringing the total number built to 444. The Viscount's pressurized and air-conditioned cabin, comparatively short landing run, and quiet, smooth turbine engines made it popular with passengers and airlines alike.

ENGINE 4 x 1,550hp Rolls-Royce Dart 506 turboprop	
WINGSPAN 93ft 9in (28.6m)	LENGTH 81ft 2in (24.7m)
CRUISING SPEED 323mph (517kph)	
PASSENGERS 59	CREW 3

